big ones. Nevertheless, this situation, commonly known as **mutually assured destruction,** also creates a kind of balance of power where the nuclear might of a state matches with that of its adversaries. This is, however, a balance of terror, and not of power, as it was evidenced during the Cold War days between the United States and the Soviet Union, which reached a climax during the Cuban Missile Crisis in 1962. However, even during the climax, both powers restrained from using nuclear power though usage would have given a lead to one over the other. Therefore, even if major wars are less frequent in a nuclear world than in a conventional system, the high intensity of such wars probably cancels out the gains from the wars. This situation is sometimes referred to as *Pax Atomica*.

Prof. Palmer and Perkins pointed out the difficulties that balance of power faced in a bipolarized world:

1. The confusing bipolar–multipolar pattern of power and the disappearance of a balancer
2. The sudden increase in the power of the offensive over the defensive and the character and the frightening implications of total war
3. Ideological considerations and other less tangible elements of power
4. The increasing disparities in the power of the states, with the superpowers becoming more powerful and the lesser states becoming weaker, at least in relative terms.[18]

Presently, with the dissolution of one of the superpowers, the post-Cold War situation drastically changed the power equation between the two poles. There was no such power transition as suggested by Organski when he said that “if great change occurs within a single lifetime, both challenger and dominant nation may find it difficult to estimate their relative power correctly, and may stumble into a war that would never have been fought if both sides had foreseen where the victory would lie”. Systemic changes took place without a general war. The changes in relative strength came from the differing economic growth rate and from the loss of allies of the Soviet Union. This left the United States as the unchallenged dominant actor in world politics. But again, another question seems to be coming up